Rajesh Dammala

Platform Engineer — Internal Platforms, Paved Roads & Developer Experience
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Open to Remote / Hybrid / On-site
https://rdammala.github.io/RD-Platform-Engineer/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Platform Engineer with 16+ years designing internal developer platforms, golden paths, and self-service tooling. Builds reusable frameworks and IaC modules (Terraform, CloudFormation) standardizing deployments across Azure and AWS, owns container platforms and orchestration (Docker, Kubernetes/AKS/EKS) with observability and security baked in, and delivered AI-driven automation auto-resolving 30-35% of incidents. Measures adoption, reliability, and developer experience and continuously improves based on feedback.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

16+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85%!’98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution across a 24/7/365 high-availability platform.
- Sustained 100% SLA across 20+ mission-critical services through disciplined incident, problem, and change management.
- Developed Python/PowerShell tooling that eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts; cut alert fatigue ~90%.
- Reduced resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.
- Partnered with R&D to make features reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable; authored 175+ runbooks.
- Coordinated 15-32 engineers across distributed teams, establishing governance, metrics, and a culture of ownership and continuous improvement.
- Drove AI/GenAI adoption (Copilot, Claude) for log summarization, code comprehension, and automation — accelerating mean time to resolution.
- Led incident, problem, and change management across 100+ services, sustaining 99.95%+ availability and authoring 175+ runbooks.
- Delivered cloud-migration patterns and IaC frameworks that modernized large-scale enterprise applications with minimal downtime.
- Built monitoring, alerting, and executive reporting that surfaced SLA risk early and improved operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Platform Engineering: Internal Developer Platforms, Paved Roads / Golden Paths, Self-Service Tooling, Reusable Frameworks, Developer Experience (DevEx)

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Standardized Modules, Configuration Management

Containers & Cloud: Docker, Kubernetes (AKS/EKS), Microsoft Azure, AWS, Cloud-Native Architecture, Autoscaling

CI/CD & Automation: Azure DevOps, GitHub / Git, CI/CD Pipelines, Python, PowerShell, Bash

Observability & Security: Azure Monitor / AppInsights, Kusto (KQL), Grafana / Datadog (concepts), Security by Default, Cost Optimization

AI & Collaboration: AI-Driven Automation, GenAI Tooling (Copilot), Adoption & Reliability Metrics, Stakeholder Communication, Documentation

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Internal Developer Platforms & Paved Roads — **Expert**
Infrastructure as Code (Terraform) — **Expert**
Container Platforms (Docker / Kubernetes) — **Advanced**
Self-Service Tooling & DevEx — **Advanced**
Observability & Autoscaling — **Advanced**
CI/CD Integration — **Advanced**
Platform-as-a-Product Metrics — **Advanced**
AI-Driven Automation — **Advanced**
CI/CD & Release Automation — **Advanced**
Containers & Orchestration (Docker / Kubernetes) — **Advanced**
Observability (Metrics / Logs / Traces) — **Advanced**
Stakeholder & Executive Communication — **Expert**
Team Leadership & Mentoring — **Expert**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Platform Engineering Lead — Xbox Cloud Services

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present
Keeps a 24/7/365 high-availability cloud platform serving millions reliable, scalable, and performant.

- Monitor, manage, and operate cloud services including end-to-end incident management for a high-availability platform; sustained 100% SLA across 20+ services.
- Developed tools and automations in Python and PowerShell (C#/.NET-class tooling) to support operations and growth, eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ redundant alerts.
- Scaled services with monitoring and alerting capabilities (Azure Monitor/AppInsights, Kusto/KQL, Power BI), providing rapid feedback and diagnostics during service disruptions.
- Architected an AI-driven incident-automation platform reaching 30-35% auto-resolution; reduced resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency 85%!'98%.
- Worked closely with R&D/Engineering to make new features reliable, easily deployable, and scalable/secure; established a regular operational feedback cycle into engineering teams.
- Maintained SLAs with a business- and customer-centric culture — incident response, problem management, and service upgrades; authored 175+ runbooks/playbooks in 5 months.

- Contributed to communication strategy for internal and external stakeholders conveying service health, SLA tracking, and incident history.
- Automated infrastructure and system-administration tasks and implemented monitoring strategy for rapid diagnostics.
- Mentored and grew engineers (15-32 across teams) into senior and lead roles; established career pathways, performance metrics, and a culture of continuous learning.
- Owned end-to-end deployment lifecycle — design, build, test, deploy — and drove operational reviews, postmortems, and continuous-improvement loops.
- Standardized documentation and knowledge management (175+ runbooks/playbooks, decision trees) to scale self-service resolution across support tiers.
- Acted as SME and escalation authority for high-impact incidents, collaborating with engineering leaders to streamline bug-fix and development cycles.
- Built executive and customer-facing reporting conveying service health, SLA tracking, and incident history to internal and external stakeholders.

Azure Cloud Reliability & Platform Technical Lead — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021
Led a 15-engineer team operating high-availability cloud infrastructure and developer tooling.

- Operated high-availability Azure cloud infrastructure; built monitoring/alerting and automation that improved reliability and productivity.
- Developed automation and internal tools (Python/PowerShell) to reduce manual operational effort and support scale.
- Partnered with R&D and Support to improve deployability, performance, and serviceability of features across the SDLC.
- Practiced Agile development with CI/CD (Azure DevOps, Git) and coding for automated testing.
- Built CI/CD pipelines and Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform, Azure DevOps, Git) standardizing deployments with security, compliance, and cost guardrails.
- Designed observability (metrics, logs, traces, dashboards, alerting) giving rapid feedback and diagnostics during service disruptions.
- Partnered cross-functionally with Engineering, Product, and Security to integrate cloud and on-premises services for secure operations.
- Led infrastructure migration methodologies and techniques to migrate large-scale enterprise applications and services.
- Practiced Agile/Scrum and DevOps with coding for automated testing, improving deployment reliability and release cadence.

Operations Lead — Azure Live Site Reliability

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016
Led 12 senior + 20 engineers operating cloud platforms at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Built PowerShell automation across provisioning, monitoring, and remediation saving thousands of manual hours.
- Designed telemetry, dashboards, and alerting for 100+ services; provided rapid diagnostics

during disruptions.

- Led incident, problem, and change management; mentored engineers into technical leads.
- Established SLA/SLO baselines, change-management governance, and on-call readiness across 100+ services at 99.95%+ availability.
- Drove cloud-migration patterns and large-scale enterprise migrations with repeatable, automated frameworks.
- Designed telemetry, dashboards, and alerting for rapid diagnostics; mentored engineers into technical leads.
- Built PowerShell/Python automation across provisioning, monitoring, and remediation, saving thousands of manual hours.

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011
Infrastructure operations and scripting across enterprise environments.

- Server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale migrations; deployed monitoring and patches.
- Scripted repetitive operational tasks to improve consistency and reduce manual effort.
- Administered RHEL/Windows environments, middleware, and databases; performed capacity planning, patching, and performance tuning.
- Authored automation and operational documentation that reduced manual effort and improved consistency.
- Executed server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale migrations; deployed monitoring and patches across enterprise environments.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

AI-Driven Incident Automation — Built an AI incident agent (30-35% auto-resolution) integrating telemetry, alerting, and remediation workflows to drive down MTTR.

Monitoring & Alerting at Scale — Designed metrics, dashboards, and alerting (Azure Monitor, KQL, Power BI) providing rapid feedback and diagnostics during disruptions.

Operational Tooling & Automation — Developed Python/PowerShell tools automating infrastructure and sysadmin tasks, eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts.

R&D Reliability Partnership — Established an operational feedback cycle into engineering to ensure new features are reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable.

SLA & Service Health Communication — Built executive and customer-facing reporting conveying service health, SLA tracking, and incident history.

CI/CD & Automated Testing — Practiced Agile development with CI/CD (Azure DevOps, Git) and coding for automated testing to raise deployment reliability.

resume-engine-pro (Personal Project) — Open-source Node.js engine that generates ATS-optimized resumes, cover letters, CVs, and themed portfolio sites from structured data — github.com/rdammala/resume-engine-pro (actively iterating on improvements).

Cloud Migration & Modernization — Defined repeatable migration patterns and IaC frameworks to move large-scale enterprise applications to the cloud with minimal downtime.

Observability & SLI/SLO Program — Rolled out metrics/logs/traces standards, dashboards, and alerting that improved detection and cut MTTR across the service portfolio.

Knowledge Management & Enablement — Built a documentation strategy (runbooks, decision trees, playbooks) that scaled self-service resolution and reduced escalations.

CI/CD & Release Automation — Designed and governed delivery pipelines (Azure DevOps, GitHub, Jenkins) with automated testing, approvals, and security/compliance gates.

Infrastructure as Code Platform — Standardized Terraform/CloudFormation modules and golden paths enabling self-service, repeatable, and auditable infrastructure provisioning.

AI-Augmented Operations — Introduced GenAI tooling (Copilot, Claude) for log summarization, code comprehension, and SQL/script generation to accelerate resolution.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

A great platform is a product, not a project: build paved roads that make the right thing the easy thing, bake in reliability and security by default, measure adoption and developer experience, and use AI to take toil off engineers so they can focus on what matters.